Interview Worksheet: Erik Vanags and Jeff Hinebaugh

Builds on the Oct 14 research brief | @Chase Beach

Date: _____ Place: _____

What changed since the brief

The story is now built around Erik's 200th win, with Jeff as co-subject. Suzy's direction (Oct 15 and 17) and Lisa's details (Oct 16 and 17) are below.

- **The hook:** win 200 came 6-0 at Ross on Aug 20, 2026, making Erik the winningest coach in Mariemont soccer history. About 207 wins going into the tournament.
- **In good company:** football's Tom Crosby (the field's namesake) has 215; lacrosse's Steve Peterson has 203.
- **Both are stepping away** after this season, after about 20 years together. Erik shares every win with Jeff.
- **Together:** 4 league titles, 11 district titles, 1 regional title and the 2020 state title (confirm all).
- **Coach of the Year for Ohio twice:** OSSCA Division II in 2015 and Division III in 2020.
- **Teaching and travel are back in:** Erik teaches social studies at MHS, and he started the student service trips (Nicaragua 2016, Ecuador 2017, Peru 2018) that became the Warriors BEyond Global Travel program.
- **One joint interview,** not one-on-ones. Record with Otter and Voice Memos. Address questions by name and turn to Jeff on purpose.

> **Don't mention** that Lisa brought the story to Suzy. Frame it as Suzy's assignment.

1. Before we start

1.1 Erik, what year did you become head coach? And what year did you come to Mariemont?
Sources say head coach since 2010, 2011 or 2012; Mariemont since 2007 or 2008.

1.2 Is it OK to say in print that this is your last season? How would you like it described?
Suzy's options: "passing the baton," "passing the torch," "moving on to other endeavors."

2. The 200th win

2.1 ★ Erik, take me back to the night at Ross. Did you know it was number 200? What happened after?

2.2 Jeff, what was it like on the bench when it was over?

2.3 What's the official total today, and what's the program's all-time win total since 1976?
Lisa: about 207, and roughly half of all program wins. Who held the record before?

2.4 Tom Crosby has 215 and Steve Peterson has 203. What does it mean to be in that company?

2.5 ★ Of all those wins, which one do you think about most?

3. Erik and Jeff: 20 years together

The heart of the piece. Ask each about the other.

3.1 ★ How did the two of you end up coaching together? What's your first memory of each other?

3.2 How do you split the work? Who's the tactician and who's the motivator?

3.3 ★ Erik, what has Jeff given this program that people don't see?

3.4 ★ Jeff, same question about Erik.

3.5 What's the story you two always tell?

3.6 Are these right: 4 league titles, 11 district titles, a regional title and the state title?

4. The 2020 state title

23-0. Beat Cardinal Mooney 4-1 at MAPFRE Stadium on Nov 14, 2020. Luke Brothers scored twice; Jimmy Sauter and Henry Buck once each.

4.1 ★ What do you remember from the final whistle?

4.2 That season happened during COVID. What did it take to keep it going, and what did it mean to the town?

4.3 When did you first think that team could win it all?

5. For Erik

5.1 Why did you leave Milford for Mariemont?

5.2 How does teaching social studies shape the way you coach, and the other way around?

5.3 ★ Tell me about starting the student service trips. What did it take to get that first one approved?

Nicaragua 2016, Ecuador 2017 (the Amazon, then the Galápagos), Peru 2018. Ask what they built in Ecuador.

5.4 Do you remember my freshman class? What was that first year at Mariemont like?

6. For Jeff

6.1 ★ Why does a busy litigation partner spend 20-plus falls coaching high school soccer?

6.2 Did you play? Where, and what position?

6.3 What does Mariemont mean to you beyond soccer, with the School Foundation and everything else?

7. Stepping away

Save for the end. The best closing quote for the article usually comes from here.

7.1 ★ Why is this the right time to step away?

7.2 ★ What's next for each of you?

7.3 What do you hope the next coaches keep?

7.4 ★ If you could say one thing to every player you've coached, what would it be?

8. Wrap-up

8.1 What didn't I ask that I should have?

8.2 Suzy suggested I talk to Nerl. Who is that, and how do I reach him?

8.3 Is the school planning any recognition, like at the November awards night?

8.4 Do you have photos I could use, from the early years or the 2020 run? Who should get credit?

Who else should I talk to?

Aim for 2 to 3 outside voices: a current senior, a 2020 state champion, a parent or the athletic director.

Name	Role	Phone or email	Notes

Before you leave

- [ ] Confirm the spelling of every name they mentioned.
- [ ] Take photos of Erik and Jeff together at Kusel Stadium.
- [ ] Ask if it's OK to text follow-up questions.
- [ ] Thank them, and mention the Nov 1 deadline.
- [ ] Send a thank-you text the same day.
- [ ] Write first impressions and details the audio missed within an hour.

Notes